

Token Marketplace Monetization Strategy

Sell token access to consumers, let publishers monetize tools, agents, APIs, workflows, and data services, and protect platform margin through price bands, usage floors, and net-revenue share.

75-90%	30%+
publisher payout range	minimum gross margin
\$5-60	0%
publisher price band / 1M tokens	platform take on first \$10K GMV

1. Consumer Pricing

Tier	Price	Included	Overage	Target
Sandbox	Free	100K/mo	-	Trial, testing
Developer	\$49/mo	3M	\$18 / 1M	Builders, indie teams
Team	\$299/mo	30M	\$12 / 1M	Growing teams
Business	\$1,499/mo	200M	\$9 / 1M	Production usage
Enterprise	\$10K+ commit	Custom	\$5-8 / 1M	High-volume, private deployments

2. Token Pack Add-Ons

Pack	Price	Effective Rate
1M tokens	\$25	\$25 / 1M
10M tokens	\$199	\$19.90 / 1M
100M tokens	\$1,499	\$14.99 / 1M
1B tokens	Custom	\$5-8 / 1M

Recommended Launch Move

0% platform take on each publisher's first \$10K GMV. Then graduate to standard commission. This attracts supply fast without permanently weakening platform margins.

Publisher Monetization

Publishers set prices inside controlled bands. Consumers pay in tokens. Payouts are calculated from net marketplace revenue after pass-through model/API cost and payment processing.

3. Publisher Pricing Bands

Listing Type	Suggested Price
Utility tools / simple APIs	\$2-6 / 1M tokens
Specialized workflows	\$8-20 / 1M tokens
Premium agents / proprietary data	\$25-60 / 1M tokens
Regulated / verified enterprise tools	Custom + minimum monthly commit

4. Publisher Commission

Publisher Tier	Publisher Share	Platform Take
Standard	75%	25%
Verified	80%	20%
Enterprise / private offers	85%	15%
Strategic exclusive publishers	90%	10% for first 12 months

Unit Economics Example

Consumer pays **\$12 per 1M tokens**. Pass-through cost is **\$3**. Net marketplace revenue is **\$9**. Verified publisher earns **\$7.20**; platform keeps **\$1.80**.

Hard Pricing Rules

- 1. Minimum platform gross margin: **30%**.
- 2. Charge input + output + tool execution tokens.
- 3. Cached/reused tokens bill at **20% rate**.
- 4. Refund failed executions automatically.
- 5. Rank publishers by usage, retention, latency, refund rate, and security score.
- 6. Enforce price floors and ceilings by listing category.

Formula: Consumer price - pass-through AI/API cost - payment processing = net marketplace revenue. Publisher share is paid from net revenue.

Benchmark logic: Token billing follows current AI API norms from OpenAI and Anthropic. Marketplace take rate is positioned between enterprise marketplaces and app-store style ecosystems. Sources: openai.com, anthropic.com, microsoft.com, google.com, apple.com, shopify.dev.